The Fourteen Points

President Woodrow Wilson · January 8, 1918

Source: Woodrow Wilson, The Fourteen Points (1918). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> Wilson's blueprint for a lasting peace after World War I — open diplomacy, freedom of the seas, self-determination, and a "general association of nations" that became the League of Nations.

I. Open covenants of peace, openly arrived at, after which there shall be no private international understandings of any kind but diplomacy shall proceed always frankly and in the public view. II. Absolute freedom of navigation upon the seas, outside territorial waters, alike in peace and in war, except as the seas may be closed in whole or in part by international action for the enforcement of international covenants. III. The removal, so far as possible, of all economic barriers and the establishment of an equality of trade conditions among all the nations consenting to the peace and associating themselves for its maintenance. IV. Adequate guarantees given and taken that national armaments will be reduced to the lowest point consistent with domestic safety.

[. . .]

XIV. A general association of nations must be formed under specific covenants for the purpose of affording mutual guarantees of political independence and territorial integrity to great and small states alike.